

Preparation for IELTS General Training
For the 2009 Updated Syllabus

IELTS Target 5.0

Chris Gough

Leading to IELTS Academic
Course Book



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Và nhiều tài liệu hấp dẫn khác!

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Contents

Book map	4
Introduction	7
General Training	
Section 1	
Unit 1 Life	10
Unit 2 Learning	22
Unit 3 Work	34
Unit 4 Achievements	46
Unit 5 Thoughts	58
Review 1	70
Section 2	
Unit 6 Place	74
Unit 7 Movement	86
Unit 8 Time	98
Unit 9 Money	110
Unit 10 Feelings	122
Review 2	134
Section 3	
Unit 11 Health	138
Unit 12 Nature	150
Unit 13 Construction	162
Unit 14 Technology	174
Unit 15 Society	186
Review 3	200
Key exam vocabulary	204
Academic section	
Introduction	207
Unit 1 Work	212
Unit 2 Technology	222
Unit 3 Health	232
Unit 4 Society	242
Unit 5 Movement	252
Key exam vocabulary	264
Answer key	266
Tapescript	277

Book map

General Training

Unit 1 Life

Speaking	personal information
Vocabulary	family / stages of life
Listening	listening for specific information
Reading	skimming
Writing	organizing / types of letter / beginnings and endings / a personal letter

Unit 2 Learning

Speaking	looking back / answering questions about the past
Vocabulary	subjects at school / expressing preferences
Listening	listening for numbers and dates
Reading	scanning / short answers
Writing	structuring a letter / stating your purpose / closing a letter

Unit 3 Work

Speaking	talking about work and jobs / introduction to exam task 2
Vocabulary	work / jobs / liking and disliking a job
Listening	listening for gist
Reading	scanning for paraphrased language
Writing	register / a letter of application

Unit 4 Achievements

Speaking	talking about success / answering exam task 3 type questions / two-way discussion
Vocabulary	success and achievements
Listening	predicting content / listening for paraphrased language
Reading	making sure that information is given in the text / recognizing distracters
Writing	understanding the task / deciding what to say / organizing your points

Unit 5 Thoughts

Speaking	how people think / expressing opinions / using the right expression
Vocabulary	ways of thinking
Listening	understanding and labelling diagrams
Reading	guessing unknown words and phrases / understanding new words and phrases from words you already know
Writing	understanding instructions / presenting a balanced argument

Unit 6 Place

Speaking	describing where you live / talking about towns and cities / comparing places
Vocabulary	places / describing places
Listening	maps and plans / noticing how information is repeated
Reading	paragraphs / topic sentences
Writing	paragraphs and topic sentences / supporting sentences

Unit 7 Movement

Speaking	saying how often you do something / answering questions about travel / expressing opinions
Vocabulary	methods of transport / ways of travelling
Listening	completing a summary / making sure answers fit
Reading	recognizing facts and opinions
Writing	linking words

Unit 8 Time

Speaking	talking about time / questions and answers / answering the question
Vocabulary	time or no time / time expressions
Listening	completing a table
Reading	completing a summary with a choice of words / making sure answers fit
Writing	making a request

Unit 9 Money

Speaking	talking about money / shopping habits and preferences / expressing opinions / follow-up comments
Vocabulary	comparing time and money / words with opposite meaning
Listening	identifying key words that you don't know
Reading	understanding references
Writing	elements of a good composition / introducing opinions

Unit 10 Feelings

Speaking	saying how you feel / disagreeing politely
Vocabulary	situations and feelings / extreme adjectives
Listening	classifying
Reading	using topic sentences to predict
Writing	complaining and requesting / linking words

Unit 11 Health

Speaking	lifestyle / talking about health problems / telling stories
Vocabulary	typical health problems / accidents
Listening	flow charts
Reading	sentence completion
Writing	writing a discursive composition / nouns that add cohesion

Unit 12 Nature

Speaking	talking about climate, weather and temperature / answering the question properly
Vocabulary	climate / weather conditions
Listening	recognizing register / understanding formal and informal language
Reading	recognizing different text types
Writing	deciding what to say / writing the main part of a composition

Unit 13 Construction

Speaking	talking about home and neighbourhood / contrasting ideas
Vocabulary	describing your home / neighbourhood
Listening	spelling answers correctly
Reading	coping with longer texts
Writing	a letter of complaint / spelling and punctuation

Unit 14 Technology

Speaking	talking about technology / giving examples
Vocabulary	machines, appliances, devices and gadgets / effect verbs
Listening	understanding different accents
Reading	timing yourself / improving your reading speed
Writing	having enough to say / making sure you write enough

Unit 15 Society

Speaking	discussing social issues / fitting a punishment to a crime / explaining what you mean when you can't remember a word
Vocabulary	social issues / crime and punishment
Listening	transferring answers to the answer sheet
Reading	checking your answers on the answer sheet
Writing	choosing what to say and how to say it

Book map

Academic section

Unit 1	Life
Reading	applying your reading skills to an academic text
Writing	interpreting and describing bar charts
Unit 2	Learning
Reading	reading for gist / reading for detail / dealing with unknown vocabulary
Writing	interpreting and describing pie charts
Unit 3	Work
Reading	recognizing paraphrased language / dealing with statistics
Writing	interpreting and describing line graphs / linking a description together
Unit 4	Achievements
Reading	understanding references and linking
Writing	describing a flow chart / using the passive to describe a process / linking a description of a process together
Unit 5	Thoughts
Reading	timing yourself / checking answers
Writing	composition content (difference between General Training and Academic writing task 2) / improving compositions for the Academic exam

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Introduction

How this course works

IELTS Target 5.0 is aimed at students who want to take the IELTS exam while studying at a pre-intermediate level. The aim is to prepare you for the General Training exam rather than the Academic exam, though some additional Academic exam practice is provided at the end of the course.

Scoring 5.0 in the General Training exam is more realistic than doing so in the Academic exam. The length and academic content of the reading passages in the Academic exam, together with the more challenging writing tasks, makes the Academic course far more demanding.

This book consists of 15 units (with an additional five units for the Academic section) and develops in terms of challenge, to take you from a strong elementary to intermediate level. The earlier units focus on basic skills and basic language, including sentence structure and spelling. The texts and recordings are short and simplified to guide you and give you confidence. By the end of the course, you will be tackling texts and working with language that is close to the level of what you will deal with in the exam.

Each unit consists of five modules, which are briefly summarized below.

Speaking and Vocabulary

The focus is on speaking exam practice and preparing you for the type of interaction you can expect with the examiner. There is frequent practice in understanding and answering appropriately the type of questions that the examiner is likely to ask. The vocabulary selected is the vocabulary that you are most likely to need during the speaking exam. You are also encouraged to record and revise vocabulary that is particular to your interests, and that you will need to remember in order to talk fluently about your life. There are frequent reflective tasks that allow you to assess your progress and talk about concerns you may have.

IELTS Target 5.0 doesn't have a grammar syllabus. Grammar is dealt with mainly as revision, as it is assumed that you will be studying grammar on a general English course at the same time you work through this course. Some major grammar points are dealt with a little more thoroughly, but generally the aim is to develop your ability to use the grammar to communicate or to recognize it when you are reading.

The grammar checks in each unit focus attention on key grammar points as they arise. If you feel that you need further practice with a particular grammar point, you should use an appropriate grammar resource in your own time or ask your teacher to help you in the lesson.

The speaking section in each unit focuses attention on a key pronunciation point. Sometimes this involves practising difficult individual phonemes, and sometimes it involves working with stress and intonation. These points are there to help improve your pronunciation in the Speaking Module of the exam.

Listening

The Listening Module is roughly divided into two parts. The first part aims to engage you in a topic, pre-teach key vocabulary and then focus on a key skill or particular IELTS exam technique. The second part aims to practise the skill or technique, and then encourage

you to reflect and develop. Each unit focuses on a different skill or technique, but those skills and techniques are revised as the course progresses. All listening tasks are just like the ones you will tackle in the exam.

Reading

The Reading Module is designed like the Listening Module. Earlier units focus on a number of short texts and general reading skills, while later units deal with longer texts and provide practice with specific exam technique.

Both the Listening and Reading Modules end with a focus on key vocabulary in context. The aim here is to focus on the semi-formal vocabulary that you are likely to meet in the recordings and texts which make up the IELTS exam. Sometimes you are encouraged to select vocabulary from a text that you think will be particularly useful to you and that you should record and revise.

Writing

The Writing Module focuses equally on the two parts of the writing exam. Earlier units focus more on correspondence tasks – letter and e-mail writing – while later units focus on the more challenging discursive compositions. Each unit provides analysis of and practice with a particular writing skill or writing technique that is required for the exam. There is a focus on step-by-step guided writing, and there are model compositions for all of the writing tasks.

Consolidation and Exam Practice

This is divided into two parts. The first part revises the speaking focus and vocabulary presented in the first module. Occasionally, a speaking skill will be developed and there might be a new focus. The second part practises listening, reading or writing skills under something closer to exam conditions. The units in the first section of the book practise two skills with short tasks that students are able to manage. The units in the second two sections focus on one skill and provide fuller exam practice.

Exam tips and Question-type tips

These tips occur all the way through the course. They are there to help you know how to approach the various tasks that make up the exam, and to provide advice on how to go about getting the highest score possible in the exam. They also give advice that will help you to improve your all-round level of general English.

Reviews

There is a review at the end of each of the three sections. The aim is not simply to revise language that has been learnt, but to reflect on what has been achieved and what needs most work. There are tasks that encourage you to revise the vocabulary you have learnt independently and to reflect on which of it is most useful to you.

Mock tests

There are three mock tests provided as pamphlets in the book. The first two tests are designed to be slightly more challenging than the content of the course, but not quite as challenging as the actual exam. The third mock test is at the level you can expect from the exam. You should do the tests when you have completed the relevant section of the Course Book, i.e., test 1 when you have completed the first section and so on.

Workbook

There are Workbook tasks for each of the first four modules in the Course Book units. You might complete these tasks in class if your teacher feels that you need further practice with a point, or complete them for homework. In the Course Book Reading Modules, direct reference is made to these Workbook tasks, as the tasks specifically focus on the content of the Reading Module.

As you work through the course, you will learn more about the exam and what you have to do in each module. By the end of the course, you will know everything about every part of the exam and what is expected of you. When you have finished the General Training course, you will be ready to either sit the General Training exam or to take a short course that will prepare you for the Academic exam.

IELTS Target 5.0 Academic

Some students are studying at a pre-intermediate or intermediate level, but need to pass the Academic IELTS exam in order to enter university or apply for a job. At the end of IELTS Target 5.0 General Training, there is a short course that provides practice specifically for the Academic exam.

IELTS Target 5.0 Academic focuses on the reading and writing skills that you need to progress toward the Academic exam, and will prepare you to sit the exam within a few weeks. There is a longer introduction to IELTS Target 5.0 Academic and some introductory tasks for you to complete at the beginning of that section.